

My experience in the SkillsBuild Program on Artificial Intelligence

1. Personal Introduction: My name is Sagar Santosh Padvalkar, and I am from Vasco Da Gama, Goa. I am currently studying TY Bcom (Banking and finance service) at Dnyanprasarak Mandal's College and Research Centre. I don't have parents, but I have elder brother. Pursuing higher education required careful financial planning, which often limited my ability to enroll in paid specialized technical certifications.

2. Life Before Joining IBM SkillsBuild: Before joining IBM SkillsBuild, I was primarily focusing on my regular college curriculum. While I knew I wanted a career in Data Analytics or Web Development, I lacked practical, industry-relevant skills. Premium online courses were often too expensive for me to afford, making it difficult to gain hands-on experience or stay competitive.

3. Family Background & Support: I lost my parents when I was 9 years and for 10 years I have been in a child care house, and now my brother is supporting me with college expenses.

4. How I Found IBM SkillsBuild & Initial Doubts: I first learned about IBM SkillsBuild through AICTE Internship portal. At first, I was hesitant because I doubted whether a free platform could offer in-depth, quality learning or real mentorship. However, seeing the backing of IBM encouraged me to sign up.

5. What I Learned & Specific Examples: Through IBM SkillsBuild, I completed tracks in Python Basics, Data analytics. I worked on building a web application, which taught me how real-world developers solve problems.

6. Changes Since Completing the Program: Since finishing the program, I built a full python web page project. Even beyond the certificate, my confidence shifted noticeably. For example, during a recent presentation in college, I was able to comfortably explain technical topics because of the hands-on practice I gained during the program.

7. Advice to Hesitant Students: If anyone is on the fence about joining, don't overthink it, just start. IBM SkillsBuild gives you industry-standard learning without any financial burden. The practical knowledge and structured paths save you months of trying to figure out what to learn on your own.

8. Future Plans: I plan to apply the technical and soft skills I gained directly into my final-year project. Moving forward, the foundation built here will help me stand out in technical interviews and adapt faster when I step into the corporate world.